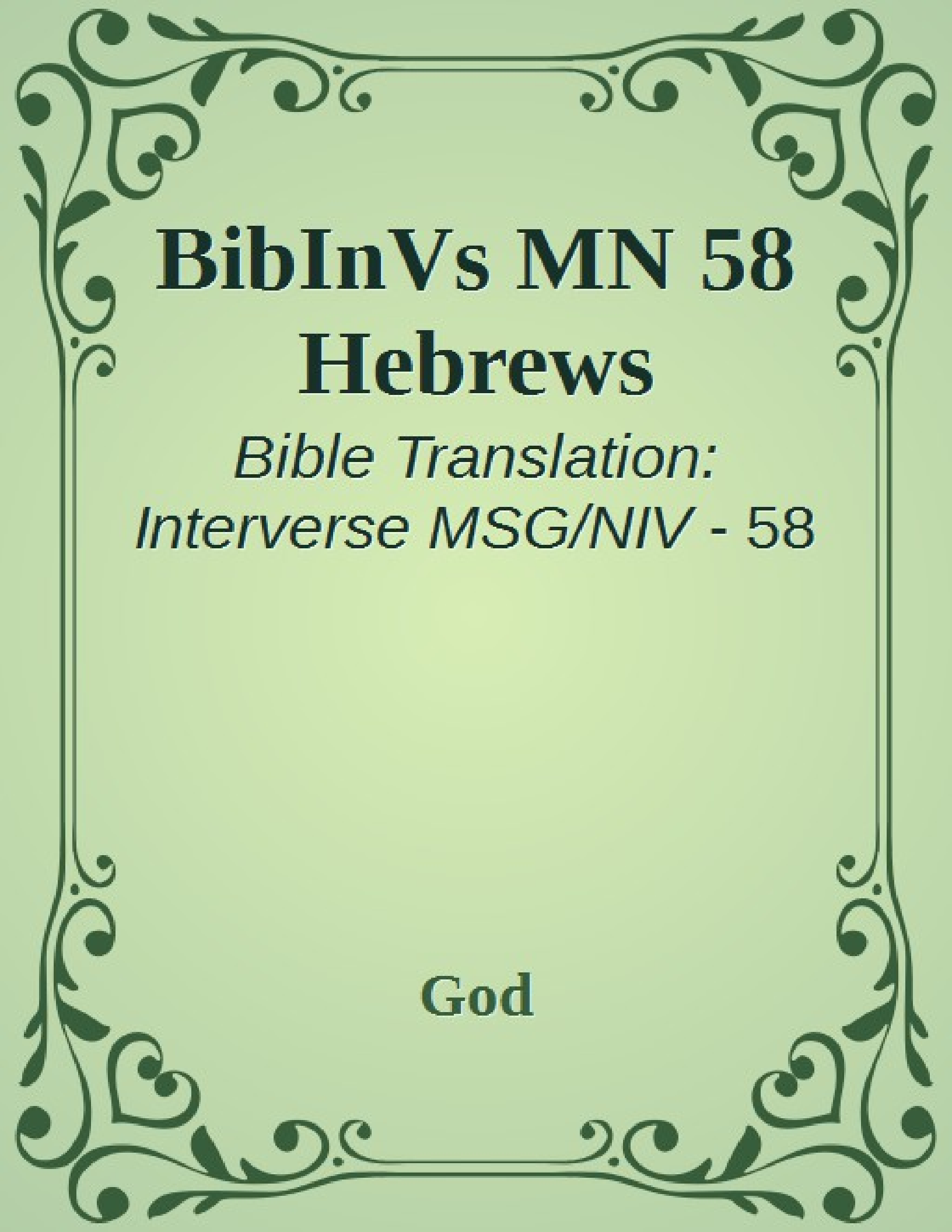


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 58

Hebrews

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 58*

God

Table of Contents

Hebrews 1
Hebrews 2
Hebrews 3
Hebrews 4
Hebrews 5
Hebrews 6
Hebrews 7
Hebrews 8
Hebrews 9
Hebrews 10
Hebrews 11
Hebrews 12
Hebrews 13

Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Hebrews

Hebrews 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 Going through a long line of prophets, God has been addressing our ancestors in different ways for centuries.
- 1 In the past God spoke to our forefathers through the prophets at many times and in various ways,
- 2 Recently he spoke to us directly through his Son. By his Son, God created the world in the beginning, and it will all belong to the Son at the end.
- 2 but in these last days he has spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed heir of all things, and through whom he made the universe.
- 3 This Son perfectly mirrors God, and is stamped with God's nature. He holds everything together by what he says--powerful words! After he finished the sacrifice for sins, the Son took his honored place high in the heavens right alongside God,
- 3 The Son is the radiance of God's glory and the exact representation of his being, sustaining all things by his powerful word. After he had provided purification for sins, he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty in heaven.
- 4 far higher than any angel in rank and rule.
- 4 So he became as much superior to the angels as the name he has inherited is superior to theirs.
- 5 Did God ever say to an angel, "You're my Son; today I celebrate you"? Or, "I'm his Father, he's my Son"?
- 5 For to which of the angels did God ever say, "You are my Son; today I have become your Father" ? Or again, "I will be his Father, and he will be my Son" ?
- 6 When he presents his honored Son to the world, he says, "All angels must worship him."

- 6 And again, when God brings his firstborn into the world, he says, "Let all God's angels worship him."
- 7 Regarding angels he says, The messengers are winds, the servants are tongues of fire.
- 7 In speaking of the angels he says, "He makes his angels winds, his servants flames of fire."
- 8 But he says to the Son, You're God, and on the throne for good; your rule makes everything right.
- 8 But about the Son he says, "Your throne, O God, will last for ever and ever, and righteousness will be the scepter of your kingdom.
- 9 You love it when things are right; you hate it when things are wrong. That is why God, your God, poured fragrant oil on your head, Marking you out as king, far above your dear companions.
- 9 You have loved righteousness and hated wickedness; therefore God, your God, has set you above your companions by anointing you with the oil of joy."
- 10 And again to the Son, You, Master, started it all, laid earth's foundations, then crafted the stars in the sky.
- 10 He also says, "In the beginning, O Lord, you laid the foundations of the earth, and the heavens are the work of your hands.
- 11 Earth and sky will wear out, but not you; they become threadbare like an old coat;
- 11 They will perish, but you remain; they will all wear out like a garment.
- 12 You'll fold them up like a worn-out cloak, and lay them away on the shelf. But you'll stay the same, year after year; you'll never fade, you'll never wear out.
- 12 You will roll them up like a robe; like a garment they will be changed. But you remain the same, and your years will never end."
- 13 And did he ever say anything like this to an angel? Sit alongside me here on my throne Until I make your enemies a stool for your feet.
- 13 To which of the angels did God ever say, "Sit at my right hand until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet" ?
- 14 Isn't it obvious that all angels are sent to help out with those lined up to receive salvation?
- 14 Are not all angels ministering spirits sent to serve those who will inherit salvation?

Hebrews 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 It's crucial that we keep a firm grip on what we've heard so that we don't drift off.
- 1 We must pay more careful attention, therefore, to what we have heard, so that we do not drift away.
- 2 If the old message delivered by the angels was valid and nobody got away with anything,
- 2 For if the message spoken by angels was binding, and every violation and disobedience received its just punishment,
- 3 do you think we can risk neglecting this latest message, this magnificent salvation? First of all, it was delivered in person by the Master, then accurately passed on to us by those who heard it from him.
- 3 how shall we escape if we ignore such a great salvation? This salvation, which was first announced by the Lord, was confirmed to us by those who heard him.
- 4 All the while God was validating it with gifts through the Holy Spirit, all sorts of signs and miracles, as he saw fit.
- 4 God also testified to it by signs, wonders and various miracles, and gifts of the Holy Spirit distributed according to his will.
- 5 God didn't put angels in charge of this business of salvation that we're dealing with here.
- 5 It is not to angels that he has subjected the world to come, about which we are speaking.
- 6 It says in Scripture, What is man and woman that you bother with them; why take a second look their way?
- 6 But there is a place where someone has testified: "What is man that you are mindful of him, the son of man that you care for him?"
- 7 You made them not quite as high as angels, bright with Eden's dawn light;
- 7 You made him a little lower than the angels; you crowned him with glory and honor
- 8 Then you put them in charge of your entire handcrafted world. When God put them in charge of everything, nothing was excluded. But we

- don't see it yet, don't see everything under human jurisdiction.
- 8 and put everything under his feet." In putting everything under him, God left nothing that is not subject to him. Yet at present we do not see everything subject to him.
- 9 What we do see is Jesus, made "not quite as high as angels," and then, through the experience of death, crowned so much higher than any angel, with a glory "bright with Eden's dawn light." In that death, by God's grace, he fully experienced death in every person's place.
- 9 But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels, now crowned with glory and honor because he suffered death, so that by the grace of God he might taste death for everyone.
- 10 It makes good sense that the God who got everything started and keeps everything going now completes the work by making the Salvation Pioneer perfect through suffering as he leads all these people to glory.
- 10 In bringing many sons to glory, it was fitting that God, for whom and through whom everything exists, should make the author of their salvation perfect through suffering.
- 11 Since the One who saves and those who are saved have a common origin, Jesus doesn't hesitate to treat them as family,
- 11 Both the one who makes men holy and those who are made holy are of the same family. So Jesus is not ashamed to call them brothers.
- 12 saying, I'll tell my good friends, my brothers and sisters, all I know about you; I'll join them in worship and praise to you.
- 12 He says, "I will declare your name to my brothers; in the presence of the congregation I will sing your praises."
- 13 Again, he puts himself in the same family circle when he says, Even I live by placing my trust in God. And yet again, I'm here with the children God gave me.
- 13 And again, "I will put my trust in him." And again he says, "Here am I, and the children God has given me."
- 14 Since the children are made of flesh and blood, it's logical that the Savior took on flesh and blood in order to rescue them by his death. By embracing death, taking it into himself, he destroyed the Devil's hold on death
- 14 Since the children have flesh and blood, he too shared in their humanity so that by his death he might destroy him who holds the power of death--

- that is, the devil--
- 15 and freed all who cower through life, scared to death of death.
- 15 and free those who all their lives were held in slavery by their fear of death.
- 16 It's obvious, of course, that he didn't go to all this trouble for angels. It was for people like us, children of Abraham.
- 16 For surely it is not angels he helps, but Abraham's descendants.
- 17 That's why he had to enter into every detail of human life. Then, when he came before God as high priest to get rid of the people's sins,
- 17 For this reason he had to be made like his brothers in every way, in order that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest in service to God, and that he might make atonement for the sins of the people.
- 18 he would have already experienced it all himself--all the pain, all the testing--and would be able to help where help was needed.
- 18 Because he himself suffered when he was tempted, he is able to help those who are being tempted.

Hebrews 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 So, my dear Christian friends, companions in following this call to the heights, take a good hard look at Jesus. He's the centerpiece of everything we believe,
- 1 Therefore, holy brothers, who share in the heavenly calling, fix your thoughts on Jesus, the apostle and high priest whom we confess.
- 2 faithful in everything God gave him to do. Moses was also faithful,
- 2 He was faithful to the one who appointed him, just as Moses was faithful in all God's house.
- 3 but Jesus gets far more honor. A builder is more valuable than a building any day.
- 3 Jesus has been found worthy of greater honor than Moses, just as the builder of a house has greater honor than the house itself.
- 4 Every house has a builder, but the Builder behind them all is God.
- 4 For every house is built by someone, but God is the builder of everything.

- 5 Moses did a good job in God's house, but it was all servant work, getting things ready for what was to come.
- 5 Moses was faithful as a servant in all God's house, testifying to what would be said in the future.
- 6 Christ as Son is in charge of the house. Now, if we can only keep a firm grip on this bold confidence, we're the house!
- 6 But Christ is faithful as a son over God's house. And we are his house, if we hold on to our courage and the hope of which we boast.
- 7 That's why the Holy Spirit says, Today, please listen;
- 7 So, as the Holy Spirit says: "Today, if you hear his voice,
- 8 don't turn a deaf ear as in "the bitter uprising," that time of wilderness testing!
- 8 do not harden your hearts as you did in the rebellion, during the time of testing in the desert,
- 9 Even though they watched me at work for forty years, your ancestors refused to let me do it my way; over and over they tried my patience.
- 9 where your fathers tested and tried me and for forty years saw what I did.
- 10 And I was provoked, oh, so provoked! I said, "They'll never keep their minds on God; they refuse to walk down my road."
- 10 That is why I was angry with that generation, and I said, 'Their hearts are always going astray, and they have not known my ways.'
- 11 Exasperated, I vowed, "They'll never get where they're going, never be able to sit down and rest."
- 11 So I declared on oath in my anger, 'They shall never enter my rest.' "
- 12 So watch your step, friends. Make sure there's no evil unbelief lying around that will trip you up and throw you off course, diverting you from the living God.
- 12 See to it, brothers, that none of you has a sinful, unbelieving heart that turns away from the living God.
- 13 For as long as it's still God's Today, keep each other on your toes so sin doesn't slow down your reflexes.
- 13 But encourage one another daily, as long as it is called Today, so that none of you may be hardened by sin's deceitfulness.
- 14 If we can only keep our grip on the sure thing we started out with, we're in this with Christ for the long haul.

- 14 We have come to share in Christ if we hold firmly till the end the confidence we had at first.
- 15 These words keep ringing in our ears: Today, please listen; don't turn a deaf ear as in the bitter uprising.
- 15 As has just been said: "Today, if you hear his voice, do not harden your hearts as you did in the rebellion."
- 16 For who were the people who turned a deaf ear? Weren't they the very ones Moses led out of Egypt?
- 16 Who were they who heard and rebelled? Were they not all those Moses led out of Egypt?
- 17 And who was God provoked with for forty years? Wasn't it those who turned a deaf ear and ended up corpses in the wilderness?
- 17 And with whom was he angry for forty years? Was it not with those who sinned, whose bodies fell in the desert?
- 18 And when he swore that they'd never get where they were going, wasn't he talking to the ones who turned a deaf ear?
- 18 And to whom did God swear that they would never enter his rest if not to those who disobeyed?
- 19 They never got there because they never listened, never believed.
- 19 So we see that they were not able to enter, because of their unbelief.

Hebrews 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 For as long, then, as that promise of resting in him pulls us on to God's goal for us, we need to be careful that we're not disqualified.
- 1 Therefore, since the promise of entering his rest still stands, let us be careful that none of you be found to have fallen short of it.
- 2 We received the same promises as those people in the wilderness, but the promises didn't do them a bit of good because they didn't receive the promises with faith.
- 2 For we also have had the gospel preached to us, just as they did; but the message they heard was of no value to them, because those who heard did not combine it with faith.

- 3 If we believe, though, we'll experience that state of resting. But not if we don't have faith. Remember that God said, Exasperated, I vowed, "They'll never get where they're going, never be able to sit down and rest." God made that vow, even though he'd finished his part before the foundation of the world.
- 3 Now we who have believed enter that rest, just as God has said, "So I declared on oath in my anger, 'They shall never enter my rest.' " And yet his work has been finished since the creation of the world.
- 4 Somewhere it's written, "God rested the seventh day, having completed his work,"
- 4 For somewhere he has spoken about the seventh day in these words: "And on the seventh day God rested from all his work."
- 5 but in this other text he says, "They'll never be able to sit down and rest."
- 5 And again in the passage above he says, "They shall never enter my rest."
- 6 So this promise has not yet been fulfilled. Those earlier ones never did get to the place of rest because they were disobedient.
- 6 It still remains that some will enter that rest, and those who formerly had the gospel preached to them did not go in, because of their disobedience.
- 7 God keeps renewing the promise and setting the date as today, just as he did in David's psalm, centuries later than the original invitation: Today, please listen, don't turn a deaf ear . . .
- 7 Therefore God again set a certain day, calling it Today, when a long time later he spoke through David, as was said before: "Today, if you hear his voice, do not harden your hearts."
- 8 And so this is still a live promise. It wasn't canceled at the time of Joshua; otherwise, God wouldn't keep renewing the appointment for "today."
- 8 For if Joshua had given them rest, God would not have spoken later about another day.
- 9 The promise of "arrival" and "rest" is still there for God's people.
- 9 There remains, then, a Sabbath-rest for the people of God;
- 10 God himself is at rest. And at the end of the journey we'll surely rest with God.
- 10 for anyone who enters God's rest also rests from his own work, just as God did from his.

- 11 So let's keep at it and eventually arrive at the place of rest, not drop out through some sort of disobedience.
- 11 Let us, therefore, make every effort to enter that rest, so that no one will fall by following their example of disobedience.
- 12 God means what he says. What he says goes. His powerful Word is sharp as a surgeon's scalpel, cutting through everything, whether doubt or defense, laying us open to listen and obey.
- 12 For the word of God is living and active. Sharper than any double-edged sword, it penetrates even to dividing soul and spirit, joints and marrow; it judges the thoughts and attitudes of the heart.
- 13 Nothing and no one is impervious to God's Word. We can't get away from it--no matter what.
- 13 Nothing in all creation is hidden from God's sight. Everything is uncovered and laid bare before the eyes of him to whom we must give account.
- 14 Now that we know what we have--Jesus, this great High Priest with ready access to God--let's not let it slip through our fingers.
- 14 Therefore, since we have a great high priest who has gone through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold firmly to the faith we profess.
- 15 We don't have a priest who is out of touch with our reality. He's been through weakness and testing, experienced it all--all but the sin.
- 15 For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who has been tempted in every way, just as we are--yet was without sin.
- 16 So let's walk right up to him and get what he is so ready to give. Take the mercy, accept the help.
- 16 Let us then approach the throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need.

Hebrews 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Every high priest selected to represent men and women before God and offer sacrifices for their sins

- 1 Every high priest is selected from among men and is appointed to represent them in matters related to God, to offer gifts and sacrifices for sins.
- 2 should be able to deal gently with their failings, since he knows what it's like from his own experience.
- 2 He is able to deal gently with those who are ignorant and are going astray, since he himself is subject to weakness.
- 3 But that also means that he has to offer sacrifices for his own sins as well as the people's.
- 3 This is why he has to offer sacrifices for his own sins, as well as for the sins of the people.
- 4 No one elects himself to this honored position. He's called to it by God, as Aaron was.
- 4 No one takes this honor upon himself; he must be called by God, just as Aaron was.
- 5 Neither did Christ presume to set himself up as high priest, but was set apart by the One who said to him, "You're my Son; today I celebrate you!"
- 5 So Christ also did not take upon himself the glory of becoming a high priest. But God said to him, "You are my Son; today I have become your Father. "
- 6 In another place God declares, "You're a priest forever in the royal order of Melchizedek."
- 6 And he says in another place, "You are a priest forever, in the order of Melchizedek."
- 7 While he lived on earth, anticipating death, Jesus cried out in pain and wept in sorrow as he offered up priestly prayers to God. Because he honored God, God answered him.
- 7 During the days of Jesus' life on earth, he offered up prayers and petitions with loud cries and tears to the one who could save him from death, and he was heard because of his reverent submission.
- 8 Though he was God's Son, he learned trusting-obedience by what he suffered, just as we do.
- 8 Although he was a son, he learned obedience from what he suffered
- 9 Then, having arrived at the full stature of his maturity and having been announced by God as high priest in the order of Melchizedek,

- 9 and, once made perfect, he became the source of eternal salvation for all who obey him
- 10 he became the source of eternal salvation to all who believingly obey him.
- 10 and was designated by God to be high priest in the order of Melchizedek.
- 11 I have a lot more to say about this, but it is hard to get it across to you since you've picked up this bad habit of not listening.
- 11 We have much to say about this, but it is hard to explain because you are slow to learn.
- 12 By this time you ought to be teachers yourselves, yet here I find you need someone to sit down with you and go over the basics on God again, starting from square one--baby's milk, when you should have been on solid food long ago!
- 12 In fact, though by this time you ought to be teachers, you need someone to teach you the elementary truths of God's word all over again. You need milk, not solid food!
- 13 Milk is for beginners, inexperienced in God's ways;
- 13 Anyone who lives on milk, being still an infant, is not acquainted with the teaching about righteousness.
- 14 solid food is for the mature, who have some practice in telling right from wrong.
- 14 But solid food is for the mature, who by constant use have trained themselves to distinguish good from evil.

Hebrews 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 So come on, let's leave the preschool fingerpainting exercises on Christ and get on with the grand work of art. Grow up in Christ. The basic foundational truths are in place: turning your back on "salvation by self-help" and turning in trust toward God;
- 1 Therefore let us leave the elementary teachings about Christ and go on to maturity, not laying again the foundation of repentance from acts that lead to death, and of faith in God,

- 2 baptismal instructions; laying on of hands; resurrection of the dead; eternal judgment.
- 2 instruction about baptisms, the laying on of hands, the resurrection of the dead, and eternal judgment.
- 3 God helping us, we'll stay true to all that. But there's so much more. Let's get on with it!
- 3 And God permitting, we will do so.
- 4 Once people have seen the light, gotten a taste of heaven and been part of the work of the Holy Spirit,
- 4 It is impossible for those who have once been enlightened, who have tasted the heavenly gift, who have shared in the Holy Spirit,
- 5 once they've personally experienced the sheer goodness of God's Word and the powers breaking in on us--
- 5 who have tasted the goodness of the word of God and the powers of the coming age,
- 6 if then they turn their backs on it, washing their hands of the whole thing, well, they can't start over as if nothing happened. That's impossible. Why, they've re-crucified Jesus! They've repudiated him in public!
- 6 if they fall away, to be brought back to repentance, because to their loss they are crucifying the Son of God all over again and subjecting him to public disgrace.
- 7 Parched ground that soaks up the rain and then produces an abundance of carrots and corn for its gardener gets God's "Well done!"
- 7 Land that drinks in the rain often falling on it and that produces a crop useful to those for whom it is farmed receives the blessing of God.
- 8 But if it produces weeds and thistles, it's more likely to get cursed out. Fields like that are burned, not harvested.
- 8 But land that produces thorns and thistles is worthless and is in danger of being cursed. In the end it will be burned.
- 9 I'm sure that won't happen to you, friends. I have better things in mind for you--salvation things!
- 9 Even though we speak like this, dear friends, we are confident of better things in your case--things that accompany salvation.
- 10 God doesn't miss anything. He knows perfectly well all the love you've shown him by helping needy Christians, and that you keep at it.

- 10 God is not unjust; he will not forget your work and the love you have shown him as you have helped his people and continue to help them.
- 11 And now I want each of you to extend that same intensity toward a full-bodied hope, and keep at it till the finish.
- 11 We want each of you to show this same diligence to the very end, in order to make your hope sure.
- 12 Don't drag your feet. Be like those who stay the course with committed faith and then get everything promised to them.
- 12 We do not want you to become lazy, but to imitate those who through faith and patience inherit what has been promised.
- 13 When God made his promise to Abraham, he backed it to the hilt, putting his own reputation on the line.
- 13 When God made his promise to Abraham, since there was no one greater for him to swear by, he swore by himself,
- 14 He said, "I promise that I'll bless you with everything I have--bless and bless and bless!"
- 14 saying, "I will surely bless you and give you many descendants."
- 15 Abraham stuck it out and got everything that had been promised to him.
- 15 And so after waiting patiently, Abraham received what was promised.
- 16 When people make promises, they guarantee them by appeal to some authority above them so that if there is any question that they'll make good on the promise, the authority will back them up.
- 16 Men swear by someone greater than themselves, and the oath confirms what is said and puts an end to all argument.
- 17 When God wanted to guarantee his promises, he gave his word, a rock-solid guarantee--
- 17 Because God wanted to make the unchanging nature of his purpose very clear to the heirs of what was promised, he confirmed it with an oath.
- 18 God can't break his word. And because his word cannot change, the promise is likewise unchangeable. We who have run for our very lives to God have every reason to grab the promised hope with both hands and never let go.
- 18 God did this so that, by two unchangeable things in which it is impossible for God to lie, we who have fled to take hold of the hope offered to us may be greatly encouraged.

- 19 It's an unbreakable spiritual lifeline, reaching past all appearances right to the very presence of God
- 19 We have this hope as an anchor for the soul, firm and secure. It enters the inner sanctuary behind the curtain,
- 20 where Jesus, running on ahead of us, has taken up his permanent post as high priest for us, in the order of Melchizedek.
- 20 where Jesus, who went before us, has entered on our behalf. He has become a high priest forever, in the order of Melchizedek.

Hebrews 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Melchizedek was king of Salem and priest of the Highest God. He met Abraham, who was returning from "the royal massacre," and gave him his blessing.
- 1 This Melchizedek was king of Salem and priest of God Most High. He met Abraham returning from the defeat of the kings and blessed him,
- 2 Abraham in turn gave him a tenth of the spoils. "Melchizedek" means "King of Righteousness." "Salem" means "Peace." So, he is also "King of Peace."
- 2 and Abraham gave him a tenth of everything. First, his name means "king of righteousness"; then also, "king of Salem" means "king of peace."
- 3 Melchizedek towers out of the past--without record of family ties, no account of beginning or end. In this way he is like the Son of God, one huge priestly presence dominating the landscape always.
- 3 Without father or mother, without genealogy, without beginning of days or end of life, like the Son of God he remains a priest forever.
- 4 You realize just how great Melchizedek is when you see that Father Abraham gave him a tenth of the captured treasure.
- 4 Just think how great he was: Even the patriarch Abraham gave him a tenth of the plunder!
- 5 Priests descended from Levi are commanded by law to collect tithes from the people, even though they are all more or less equals, priests and people, having a common father in Abraham.

- 5 Now the law requires the descendants of Levi who become priests to collect a tenth from the people--that is, their brothers--even though their brothers are descended from Abraham.
- 6 But this man, a complete outsider, collected tithes from Abraham and blessed him, the one to whom the promises had been given.
- 6 This man, however, did not trace his descent from Levi, yet he collected a tenth from Abraham and blessed him who had the promises.
- 7 In acts of blessing, the lesser is blessed by the greater.
- 7 And without doubt the lesser person is blessed by the greater.
- 8 Or look at it this way: We pay our tithes to priests who die, but Abraham paid tithes to a priest who, the Scripture says, "lives."
- 8 In the one case, the tenth is collected by men who die; but in the other case, by him who is declared to be living.
- 9 Ultimately you could even say that since Levi descended from Abraham, who paid tithes to Melchizedek,
- 9 One might even say that Levi, who collects the tenth, paid the tenth through Abraham,
- 10 when we pay tithes to the priestly tribe of Levi they end up with Melchizedek.
- 10 because when Melchizedek met Abraham, Levi was still in the body of his ancestor.
- 11 If the priesthood of Levi and Aaron, which provided the framework for the giving of the law, could really make people perfect, there wouldn't have been need for a new priesthood like that of Melchizedek.
- 11 If perfection could have been attained through the Levitical priesthood (for on the basis of it the law was given to the people), why was there still need for another priest to come--one in the order of Melchizedek, not in the order of Aaron?
- 12 But since it didn't get the job done, there was a change of priesthood, which brought with it a radical new kind of law.
- 12 For when there is a change of the priesthood, there must also be a change of the law.
- 13 There is no way of understanding this in terms of the old Levitical priesthood,
- 13 He of whom these things are said belonged to a different tribe, and no one from that tribe has ever served at the altar.

14 which is why there is nothing in Jesus' family tree connecting him with that priestly line.

14 For it is clear that our Lord descended from Judah, and in regard to that tribe Moses said nothing about priests.

15 But the Melchizedek story provides a perfect analogy: Jesus, a priest like Melchizedek,

15 And what we have said is even more clear if another priest like Melchizedek appears,

16 not by genealogical descent but by the sheer force of resurrection life-- he lives!--

16 one who has become a priest not on the basis of a regulation as to his ancestry but on the basis of the power of an indestructible life.

17 "priest forever in the royal order of Melchizedek."

17 For it is declared: "You are a priest forever, in the order of Melchizedek."

18 The former way of doing things, a system of commandments that never worked out the way it was supposed to, was set aside;

18 The former regulation is set aside because it was weak and useless

19 the law brought nothing to maturity. Another way--Jesus!--a way that does work, that brings us right into the presence of God, is put in its place.

19 (for the law made nothing perfect), and a better hope is introduced, by which we draw near to God.

20 The old priesthood of Aaron perpetuated itself automatically, father to son, without explicit confirmation by God.

20 And it was not without an oath! Others became priests without any oath,

21 But then God intervened and called this new, permanent priesthood into being with an added promise: God gave his word; he won't take it back: "You're the permanent priest."

21 but he became a priest with an oath when God said to him: "The Lord has sworn and will not change his mind: 'You are a priest forever.' "

22 This makes Jesus the guarantee of a far better way between us and God--one that really works! A new covenant.

22 Because of this oath, Jesus has become the guarantee of a better covenant.

23 Earlier there were a lot of priests, for they died and had to be replaced.

- 23 Now there have been many of those priests, since death prevented them from continuing in office;
- 24 But Jesus' priesthood is permanent. He's there from now to eternity
- 24 but because Jesus lives forever, he has a permanent priesthood.
- 25 to save everyone who comes to God through him, always on the job to speak up for them.
- 25 Therefore he is able to save completely those who come to God through him, because he always lives to intercede for them.
- 26 So now we have a high priest who perfectly fits our needs: completely holy, uncompromised by sin, with authority extending as high as God's presence in heaven itself.
- 26 Such a high priest meets our need--one who is holy, blameless, pure, set apart from sinners, exalted above the heavens.
- 27 Unlike the other high priests, he doesn't have to offer sacrifices for his own sins every day before he can get around to us and our sins. He's done it, once and for all: offered up himself as the sacrifice.
- 27 Unlike the other high priests, he does not need to offer sacrifices day after day, first for his own sins, and then for the sins of the people. He sacrificed for their sins once for all when he offered himself.
- 28 The law appoints as high priests men who are never able to get the job done right. But this intervening command of God, which came later, appoints the Son, who is absolutely, eternally perfect.
- 28 For the law appoints as high priests men who are weak; but the oath, which came after the law, appointed the Son, who has been made perfect forever.

Hebrews 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 In essence, we have just such a high priest: authoritative right alongside God,
- 1 The point of what we are saying is this: We do have such a high priest, who sat down at the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in heaven,
- 2 conducting worship in the one true sanctuary built by God.

- 2 and who serves in the sanctuary, the true tabernacle set up by the Lord, not by man.
- 3 The assigned task of a high priest is to offer both gifts and sacrifices, and it's no different with the priesthood of Jesus.
- 3 Every high priest is appointed to offer both gifts and sacrifices, and so it was necessary for this one also to have something to offer.
- 4 If he were limited to earth, he wouldn't even be a priest. We wouldn't need him since there are plenty of priests who offer the gifts designated in the law.
- 4 If he were on earth, he would not be a priest, for there are already men who offer the gifts prescribed by the law.
- 5 These priests provide only a hint of what goes on in the true sanctuary of heaven, which Moses caught a glimpse of as he was about to set up the tent-shrine. It was then that God said, "Be careful to do it exactly as you saw it on the Mountain."
- 5 They serve at a sanctuary that is a copy and shadow of what is in heaven. This is why Moses was warned when he was about to build the tabernacle: "See to it that you make everything according to the pattern shown you on the mountain."
- 6 But Jesus' priestly work far surpasses what these other priests do, since he's working from a far better plan.
- 6 But the ministry Jesus has received is as superior to theirs as the covenant of which he is mediator is superior to the old one, and it is founded on better promises.
- 7 If the first plan--the old covenant--had worked out, a second wouldn't have been needed.
- 7 For if there had been nothing wrong with that first covenant, no place would have been sought for another.
- 8 But we know the first was found wanting, because God said, Heads up! The days are coming when I'll set up a new plan for dealing with Israel and Judah.
- 8 But God found fault with the people and said: "The time is coming, declares the Lord, when I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah.
- 9 I'll throw out the old plan I set up with their ancestors when I led them by the hand out of Egypt. They didn't keep their part of the bargain, so I

- looked away and let it go.
- 9 It will not be like the covenant I made with their forefathers when I took them by the hand to lead them out of Egypt, because they did not remain faithful to my covenant, and I turned away from them, declares the Lord.
- 10 This new plan I'm making with Israel isn't going to be written on paper, isn't going to be chiseled in stone; This time I'm writing out the plan in them, carving it on the lining of their hearts. I'll be their God, they'll be my people.
- 10 This is the covenant I will make with the house of Israel after that time, declares the Lord. I will put my laws in their minds and write them on their hearts. I will be their God, and they will be my people.
- 11 They won't go to school to learn about me, or buy a book called God in Five Easy Lessons. They'll all get to know me firsthand, the little and the big, the small and the great.
- 11 No longer will a man teach his neighbor, or a man his brother, saying, 'Know the Lord,' because they will all know me, from the least of them to the greatest.
- 12 They'll get to know me by being kindly forgiven, with the slate of their sins forever wiped clean.
- 12 For I will forgive their wickedness and will remember their sins no more."
- 13 By coming up with a new plan, a new covenant between God and his people, God put the old plan on the shelf. And there it stays, gathering dust.
- 13 By calling this covenant "new," he has made the first one obsolete; and what is obsolete and aging will soon disappear.

Hebrews 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 That first plan contained directions for worship, and a specially designed place of worship.
- 1 Now the first covenant had regulations for worship and also an earthly sanctuary.

- 2 A large outer tent was set up. The lampstand, the table, and "the bread of presence" were placed in it. This was called "the Holy Place."
- 2 A tabernacle was set up. In its first room were the lampstand, the table and the consecrated bread; this was called the Holy Place.
- 3 Then a curtain was stretched, and behind it a smaller, inside tent set up. This was called "the Holy of Holies."
- 3 Behind the second curtain was a room called the Most Holy Place,
- 4 In it were placed the gold incense altar and the gold-covered ark of the covenant containing the gold urn of manna, Aaron's rod that budded, the covenant tablets,
- 4 which had the golden altar of incense and the gold- covered ark of the covenant. This ark contained the gold jar of manna, Aaron's staff that had budded, and the stone tablets of the covenant.
- 5 and the angel-wing-shadowed mercy seat. But we don't have time to comment on these now.
- 5 Above the ark were the cherubim of the Glory, overshadowing the atonement cover. But we cannot discuss these things in detail now.
- 6 After this was set up, the priests went about their duties in the large tent.
- 6 When everything had been arranged like this, the priests entered regularly into the outer room to carry on their ministry.
- 7 Only the high priest entered the smaller, inside tent, and then only once a year, offering a blood sacrifice for his own sins and the people's accumulated sins.
- 7 But only the high priest entered the inner room, and that only once a year, and never without blood, which he offered for himself and for the sins the people had committed in ignorance.
- 8 This was the Holy Spirit's way of showing with a visible parable that as long as the large tent stands, people can't just walk in on God.
- 8 The Holy Spirit was showing by this that the way into the Most Holy Place had not yet been disclosed as long as the first tabernacle was still standing.
- 9 Under this system, the gifts and sacrifices can't really get to the heart of the matter, can't assuage the conscience of the people,
- 9 This is an illustration for the present time, indicating that the gifts and sacrifices being offered were not able to clear the conscience of the worshiper.

- 10 but are limited to matters of ritual and behavior. It's essentially a temporary arrangement until a complete overhaul could be made.
- 10 They are only a matter of food and drink and various ceremonial washings--external regulations applying until the time of the new order.
- 11 But when the Messiah arrived, high priest of the superior things of this new covenant, he bypassed the old tent and its trappings in this created world and went straight into heaven's "tent"--the true Holy Place--once and for all.
- 11 When Christ came as high priest of the good things that are already here, he went through the greater and more perfect tabernacle that is not man-made, that is to say, not a part of this creation.
- 12 He also bypassed the sacrifices consisting of goat and calf blood, instead using his own blood as the price to set us free once and for all.
- 12 He did not enter by means of the blood of goats and calves; but he entered the Most Holy Place once for all by his own blood, having obtained eternal redemption.
- 13 If that animal blood and the other rituals of purification were effective in cleaning up certain matters of our religion and behavior,
- 13 The blood of goats and bulls and the ashes of a heifer sprinkled on those who are ceremonially unclean sanctify them so that they are outwardly clean.
- 14 think how much more the blood of Christ cleans up our whole lives, inside and out.
- 14 How much more, then, will the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself unblemished to God, cleanse our consciences from acts that lead to death, so that we may serve the living God!
- 15 Through the Spirit, Christ offered himself as an unblemished sacrifice, freeing us from all those dead-end efforts to make ourselves respectable, so that we can live all out for God.
- 15 For this reason Christ is the mediator of a new covenant, that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance--now that he has died as a ransom to set them free from the sins committed under the first covenant.
- 16 Like a will that takes effect when someone dies, the new covenant was put into action at Jesus' death. His death marked the transition from the old plan to the new one, canceling the old obligations and accompanying

- sins, and summoning the heirs to receive the eternal inheritance that was promised them. He brought together God and his people in this new way.
- 16 In the case of a will, it is necessary to prove the death of the one who made it,
- 17 (SEE 9:16)
- 17 because a will is in force only when somebody has died; it never takes effect while the one who made it is living.
- 18 Even the first plan required a death to set it in motion.
- 18 This is why even the first covenant was not put into effect without blood.
- 19 After Moses had read out all the terms of the plan of the law--God's "will"--he took the blood of sacrificed animals and, in a solemn ritual, sprinkled the document and the people who were its beneficiaries.
- 19 When Moses had proclaimed every commandment of the law to all the people, he took the blood of calves, together with water, scarlet wool and branches of hyssop, and sprinkled the scroll and all the people.
- 20 And then he attested its validity with the words, "This is the blood of the covenant commanded by God."
- 20 He said, "This is the blood of the covenant, which God has commanded you to keep."
- 21 He did the same thing with the place of worship and its furniture.
- 21 In the same way, he sprinkled with the blood both the tabernacle and everything used in its ceremonies.
- 22 Moses said to the people, "This is the blood of the covenant God has established with you." Practically everything in a will hinges on a death. That's why blood, the evidence of death, is used so much in our tradition, especially regarding forgiveness of sins.
- 22 In fact, the law requires that nearly everything be cleansed with blood, and without the shedding of blood there is no forgiveness.
- 23 That accounts for the prominence of blood and death in all these secondary practices that point to the realities of heaven. It also accounts for why, when the real thing takes place, these animal sacrifices aren't needed anymore, having served their purpose.
- 23 It was necessary, then, for the copies of the heavenly things to be purified with these sacrifices, but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these.

- 24 For Christ didn't enter the earthly version of the Holy Place; he entered the Place Itself, and offered himself to God as the sacrifice for our sins.
- 24 For Christ did not enter a man-made sanctuary that was only a copy of the true one; he entered heaven itself, now to appear for us in God's presence.
- 25 He doesn't do this every year as the high priests did under the old plan with blood that was not their own;
- 25 Nor did he enter heaven to offer himself again and again, the way the high priest enters the Most Holy Place every year with blood that is not his own.
- 26 if that had been the case, he would have to sacrifice himself repeatedly throughout the course of history. But instead he sacrificed himself once and for all, summing up all the other sacrifices in this sacrifice of himself, the final solution of sin.
- 26 Then Christ would have had to suffer many times since the creation of the world. But now he has appeared once for all at the end of the ages to do away with sin by the sacrifice of himself.
- 27 Everyone has to die once, then face the consequences.
- 27 Just as man is destined to die once, and after that to face judgment,
- 28 Christ's death was also a one-time event, but it was a sacrifice that took care of sins forever. And so, when he next appears, the outcome for those eager to greet him is, precisely, salvation.
- 28 so Christ was sacrificed once to take away the sins of many people; and he will appear a second time, not to bear sin, but to bring salvation to those who are waiting for him.

Hebrews 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 The old plan was only a hint of the good things in the new plan. Since that old "law plan" wasn't complete in itself, it couldn't complete those who followed it. No matter how many sacrifices were offered year after year, they never added up to a complete solution.

- 1 The law is only a shadow of the good things that are coming-- not the realities themselves. For this reason it can never, by the same sacrifices repeated endlessly year after year, make perfect those who draw near to worship.
- 2 If they had, the worshipers would have gone merrily on their way, no longer dragged down by their sins.
- 2 If it could, would they not have stopped being offered? For the worshipers would have been cleansed once for all, and would no longer have felt guilty for their sins.
- 3 But instead of removing awareness of sin, when those animal sacrifices were repeated over and over they actually heightened awareness and guilt.
- 3 But those sacrifices are an annual reminder of sins,
- 4 The plain fact is that bull and goat blood can't get rid of sin.
- 4 because it is impossible for the blood of bulls and goats to take away sins.
- 5 That is what is meant by this prophecy, put in the mouth of Christ: You don't want sacrifices and offerings year after year; you've prepared a body for me for a sacrifice.
- 5 Therefore, when Christ came into the world, he said: "Sacrifice and offering you did not desire, but a body you prepared for me;
- 6 It's not fragrance and smoke from the altar that whet your appetite.
- 6 with burnt offerings and sin offerings you were not pleased.
- 7 So I said, "I'm here to do it your way, O God, the way it's described in your Book."
- 7 Then I said, 'Here I am--it is written about me in the scroll-- I have come to do your will, O God.' "
- 8 When he said, "You don't want sacrifices and offerings," he was referring to practices according to the old plan.
- 8 First he said, "Sacrifices and offerings, burnt offerings and sin offerings you did not desire, nor were you pleased with them" (although the law required them to be made).
- 9 When he added, "I'm here to do it your way," he set aside the first in order to enact the new plan--
- 9 Then he said, "Here I am, I have come to do your will." He sets aside the first to establish the second.

- 10 God's way--by which we are made fit for God by the once-for-all sacrifice of Jesus.
- 10 And by that will, we have been made holy through the sacrifice of the body of Jesus Christ once for all.
- 11 Every priest goes to work at the altar each day, offers the same old sacrifices year in, year out, and never makes a dent in the sin problem.
- 11 Day after day every priest stands and performs his religious duties; again and again he offers the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins.
- 12 As a priest, Christ made a single sacrifice for sins, and that was it! Then he sat down right beside God
- 12 But when this priest had offered for all time one sacrifice for sins, he sat down at the right hand of God.
- 13 and waited for his enemies to cave in.
- 13 Since that time he waits for his enemies to be made his footstool,
- 14 It was a perfect sacrifice by a perfect person to perfect some very imperfect people. By that single offering, he did everything that needed to be done for everyone who takes part in the purifying process.
- 14 because by one sacrifice he has made perfect forever those who are being made holy.
- 15 The Holy Spirit confirms this:
- 15 The Holy Spirit also testifies to us about this. First he says:
- 16 This new plan I'm making with Israel isn't going to be written on paper, isn't going to be chiseled in stone; This time "I'm writing out the plan in them, carving it on the lining of their hearts."
- 16 This is the covenant I will make with them after that time, says the Lord. I will put my laws in their hearts, and I will write them on their minds.
- 17 He concludes, I'll forever wipe the slate clean of their sins.
- 17 Then he adds: "Their sins and lawless acts I will remember no more."
- 18 Once sins are taken care of for good, there's no longer any need to offer sacrifices for them.
- 18 And where these have been forgiven, there is no longer any sacrifice for sin.
- 19 So, friends, we can now--without hesitation--walk right up to God, into "the Holy Place." Jesus has cleared the way by the blood of his sacrifice,

acting as our priest before God. The "curtain" into God's presence is his body.

19 Therefore, brothers, since we have confidence to enter the Most Holy Place by the blood of Jesus,

20 (SEE 10:19)

20 by a new and living way opened for us through the curtain, that is, his body,

21 (SEE 10:19)

21 and since we have a great priest over the house of God,

22 So let's do it--full of belief, confident that we're presentable inside and out.

22 let us draw near to God with a sincere heart in full assurance of faith, having our hearts sprinkled to cleanse us from a guilty conscience and having our bodies washed with pure water.

23 Let's keep a firm grip on the promises that keep us going. He always keeps his word.

23 Let us hold unswervingly to the hope we profess, for he who promised is faithful.

24 Let's see how inventive we can be in encouraging love and helping out,

24 And let us consider how we may spur one another on toward love and good deeds.

25 not avoiding worshiping together as some do but spurring each other on, especially as we see the big Day approaching.

25 Let us not give up meeting together, as some are in the habit of doing, but let us encourage one another--and all the more as you see the Day approaching.

26 If we give up and turn our backs on all we've learned, all we've been given, all the truth we now know, we repudiate Christ's sacrifice

26 If we deliberately keep on sinning after we have received the knowledge of the truth, no sacrifice for sins is left,

27 and are left on our own to face the Judgment--and a mighty fierce judgment it will be!

27 but only a fearful expectation of judgment and of raging fire that will consume the enemies of God.

28 If the penalty for breaking the law of Moses is physical death,

- 28 Anyone who rejected the law of Moses died without mercy on the testimony of two or three witnesses.
- 29 what do you think will happen if you turn on God's Son, spit on the sacrifice that made you whole, and insult this most gracious Spirit?
- 29 How much more severely do you think a man deserves to be punished who has trampled the Son of God under foot, who has treated as an unholy thing the blood of the covenant that sanctified him, and who has insulted the Spirit of grace?
- 30 This is no light matter. God has warned us that he'll hold us to account and make us pay. He was quite explicit: "Vengeance is mine, and I won't overlook a thing," and, "God will judge his people."
- 30 For we know him who said, "It is mine to avenge; I will repay," and again, "The Lord will judge his people."
- 31 Nobody's getting by with anything, believe me.
- 31 It is a dreadful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.
- 32 Remember those early days after you first saw the light? Those were the hard times!
- 32 Remember those earlier days after you had received the light, when you stood your ground in a great contest in the face of suffering.
- 33 Kicked around in public, targets of every kind of abuse--some days it was you, other days your friends.
- 33 Sometimes you were publicly exposed to insult and persecution; at other times you stood side by side with those who were so treated.
- 34 If some friends went to prison, you stuck by them. If some enemies broke in and seized your goods, you let them go with a smile, knowing they couldn't touch your real treasure. Nothing they did bothered you, nothing set you back.
- 34 You sympathized with those in prison and joyfully accepted the confiscation of your property, because you knew that you yourselves had better and lasting possessions.
- 35 So don't throw it all away now. You were sure of yourselves then. It's still a sure thing!
- 35 So do not throw away your confidence; it will be richly rewarded.
- 36 But you need to stick it out, staying with God's plan so you'll be there for the promised completion.

- 36 You need to persevere so that when you have done the will of God, you will receive what he has promised.
- 37 It won't be long now, he's on the way; he'll show up most any minute.
- 37 For in just a very little while, "He who is coming will come and will not delay.
- 38 But anyone who is right with me thrives on loyal trust; if he cuts and runs, I won't be very happy.
- 38 But my righteous one will live by faith. And if he shrinks back, I will not be pleased with him."
- 39 But we're not quitters who lose out. Oh, no! We'll stay with it and survive, trusting all the way.
- 39 But we are not of those who shrink back and are destroyed, but of those who believe and are saved.

Hebrews 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 The fundamental fact of existence is that this trust in God, this faith, is the firm foundation under everything that makes life worth living. It's our handle on what we can't see.
- 1 Now faith is being sure of what we hope for and certain of what we do not see.
- 2 The act of faith is what distinguished our ancestors, set them above the crowd.
- 2 This is what the ancients were commended for.
- 3 By faith, we see the world called into existence by God's word, what we see created by what we don't see.
- 3 By faith we understand that the universe was formed at God's command, so that what is seen was not made out of what was visible.
- 4 By an act of faith, Abel brought a better sacrifice to God than Cain. It was what he believed, not what he brought, that made the difference. That's what God noticed and approved as righteous. After all these centuries, that belief continues to catch our notice.
- 4 By faith Abel offered God a better sacrifice than Cain did. By faith he was commended as a righteous man, when God spoke well of his

offerings. And by faith he still speaks, even though he is dead.

- 5 By an act of faith, Enoch skipped death completely. "They looked all over and couldn't find him because God had taken him." We know on the basis of reliable testimony that before he was taken "he pleased God."
- 5 By faith Enoch was taken from this life, so that he did not experience death; he could not be found, because God had taken him away. For before he was taken, he was commended as one who pleased God.
- 6 It's impossible to please God apart from faith. And why? Because anyone who wants to approach God must believe both that he exists and that he cares enough to respond to those who seek him.
- 6 And without faith it is impossible to please God, because anyone who comes to him must believe that he exists and that he rewards those who earnestly seek him.
- 7 By faith, Noah built a ship in the middle of dry land. He was warned about something he couldn't see, and acted on what he was told. The result? His family was saved. His act of faith drew a sharp line between the evil of the unbelieving world and the rightness of the believing world. As a result, Noah became intimate with God.
- 7 By faith Noah, when warned about things not yet seen, in holy fear built an ark to save his family. By his faith he condemned the world and became heir of the righteousness that comes by faith.
- 8 By an act of faith, Abraham said yes to God's call to travel to an unknown place that would become his home. When he left he had no idea where he was going.
- 8 By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going.
- 9 By an act of faith he lived in the country promised him, lived as a stranger camping in tents. Isaac and Jacob did the same, living under the same promise.
- 9 By faith he made his home in the promised land like a stranger in a foreign country; he lived in tents, as did Isaac and Jacob, who were heirs with him of the same promise.
- 10 Abraham did it by keeping his eye on an unseen city with real, eternal foundations--the City designed and built by God.

- 10 For he was looking forward to the city with foundations, whose architect and builder is God.
- 11 By faith, barren Sarah was able to become pregnant, old woman as she was at the time, because she believed the One who made a promise would do what he said.
- 11 By faith Abraham, even though he was past age--and Sarah herself was barren--was enabled to become a father because he considered him faithful who had made the promise.
- 12 That's how it happened that from one man's dead and shriveled loins there are now people numbering into the millions.
- 12 And so from this one man, and he as good as dead, came descendants as numerous as the stars in the sky and as countless as the sand on the seashore.
- 13 Each one of these people of faith died not yet having in hand what was promised, but still believing. How did they do it? They saw it way off in the distance, waved their greeting, and accepted the fact that they were transients in this world.
- 13 All these people were still living by faith when they died. They did not receive the things promised; they only saw them and welcomed them from a distance. And they admitted that they were aliens and strangers on earth.
- 14 People who live this way make it plain that they are looking for their true home.
- 14 People who say such things show that they are looking for a country of their own.
- 15 If they were homesick for the old country, they could have gone back any time they wanted.
- 15 If they had been thinking of the country they had left, they would have had opportunity to return.
- 16 But they were after a far better country than that--heaven country. You can see why God is so proud of them, and has a City waiting for them.
- 16 Instead, they were longing for a better country--a heavenly one. Therefore God is not ashamed to be called their God, for he has prepared a city for them.
- 17 By faith, Abraham, at the time of testing, offered Isaac back to God. Acting in faith, he was as ready to return the promised son, his only son,

as he had been to receive him--

17 By faith Abraham, when God tested him, offered Isaac as a sacrifice. He who had received the promises was about to sacrifice his one and only son,

18 and this after he had already been told, "Your descendants shall come from Isaac."

18 even though God had said to him, "It is through Isaac that your offspring will be reckoned."

19 Abraham figured that if God wanted to, he could raise the dead. In a sense, that's what happened when he received Isaac back, alive from off the altar.

19 Abraham reasoned that God could raise the dead, and figuratively speaking, he did receive Isaac back from death.

20 By an act of faith, Isaac reached into the future as he blessed Jacob and Esau.

20 By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and Esau in regard to their future.

21 By an act of faith, Jacob on his deathbed blessed each of Joseph's sons in turn, blessing them with God's blessing, not his own--as he bowed worshipfully upon his staff.

21 By faith Jacob, when he was dying, blessed each of Joseph's sons, and worshiped as he leaned on the top of his staff.

22 By an act of faith, Joseph, while dying, prophesied the exodus of Israel, and made arrangements for his own burial.

22 By faith Joseph, when his end was near, spoke about the exodus of the Israelites from Egypt and gave instructions about his bones.

23 By an act of faith, Moses' parents hid him away for three months after his birth. They saw the child's beauty, and they braved the king's decree.

23 By faith Moses' parents hid him for three months after he was born, because they saw he was no ordinary child, and they were not afraid of the king's edict.

24 By faith, Moses, when grown, refused the privileges of the Egyptian royal house.

24 By faith Moses, when he had grown up, refused to be known as the son of Pharaoh's daughter.

25 He chose a hard life with God's people rather than an opportunistic soft life of sin with the oppressors.

- 25 He chose to be mistreated along with the people of God rather than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a short time.
- 26 He valued suffering in the Messiah's camp far greater than Egyptian wealth because he was looking ahead, anticipating the payoff.
- 26 He regarded disgrace for the sake of Christ as of greater value than the treasures of Egypt, because he was looking ahead to his reward.
- 27 By an act of faith, he turned his heel on Egypt, indifferent to the king's blind rage. He had his eye on the One no eye can see, and kept right on going.
- 27 By faith he left Egypt, not fearing the king's anger; he persevered because he saw him who is invisible.
- 28 By an act of faith, he kept the Passover Feast and sprinkled Passover blood on each house so that the destroyer of the firstborn wouldn't touch them.
- 28 By faith he kept the Passover and the sprinkling of blood, so that the destroyer of the firstborn would not touch the firstborn of Israel.
- 29 By an act of faith, Israel walked through the Red Sea on dry ground. The Egyptians tried it and drowned.
- 29 By faith the people passed through the Red Sea as on dry land; but when the Egyptians tried to do so, they were drowned.
- 30 By faith, the Israelites marched around the walls of Jericho for seven days, and the walls fell flat.
- 30 By faith the walls of Jericho fell, after the people had marched around them for seven days.
- 31 By an act of faith, Rahab, the Jericho harlot, welcomed the spies and escaped the destruction that came on those who refused to trust God.
- 31 By faith the prostitute Rahab, because she welcomed the spies, was not killed with those who were disobedient.
- 32 I could go on and on, but I've run out of time. There are so many more-- Gideon, Barak, Samson, Jephthah, David, Samuel, the prophets. . . .
- 32 And what more shall I say? I do not have time to tell about Gideon, Barak, Samson, Jephthah, David, Samuel and the prophets,
- 33 Through acts of faith, they toppled kingdoms, made justice work, took the promises for themselves. They were protected from lions,
- 33 who through faith conquered kingdoms, administered justice, and gained what was promised; who shut the mouths of lions,

- 34 fires, and sword thrusts, turned disadvantage to advantage, won battles, routed alien armies.
- 34 quenched the fury of the flames, and escaped the edge of the sword; whose weakness was turned to strength; and who became powerful in battle and routed foreign armies.
- 35 Women received their loved ones back from the dead. There were those who, under torture, refused to give in and go free, preferring something better: resurrection.
- 35 Women received back their dead, raised to life again. Others were tortured and refused to be released, so that they might gain a better resurrection.
- 36 Others braved abuse and whips, and, yes, chains and dungeons.
- 36 Some faced jeers and flogging, while still others were chained and put in prison.
- 37 We have stories of those who were stoned, sawed in two, murdered in cold blood; stories of vagrants wandering the earth in animal skins, homeless, friendless, powerless--
- 37 They were stoned; they were sawed in two; they were put to death by the sword. They went about in sheepskins and goatskins, destitute, persecuted and mistreated--
- 38 the world didn't deserve them!--making their way as best they could on the cruel edges of the world.
- 38 the world was not worthy of them. They wandered in deserts and mountains, and in caves and holes in the ground.
- 39 Not one of these people, even though their lives of faith were exemplary, got their hands on what was promised.
- 39 These were all commended for their faith, yet none of them received what had been promised.
- 40 God had a better plan for us: that their faith and our faith would come together to make one completed whole, their lives of faith not complete apart from ours.
- 40 God had planned something better for us so that only together with us would they be made perfect.

Hebrews 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 Do you see what this means--all these pioneers who blazed the way, all these veterans cheering us on? It means we'd better get on with it. Strip down, start running--and never quit! No extra spiritual fat, no parasitic sins.
- 1 Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses, let us throw off everything that hinders and the sin that so easily entangles, and let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us.
- 2 Keep your eyes on Jesus, who both began and finished this race we're in. Study how he did it. Because he never lost sight of where he was headed--that exhilarating finish in and with God--he could put up with anything along the way: cross, shame, whatever. And now he's there, in the place of honor, right alongside God.
- 2 Let us fix our eyes on Jesus, the author and perfecter of our faith, who for the joy set before him endured the cross, scorning its shame, and sat down at the right hand of the throne of God.
- 3 When you find yourselves flagging in your faith, go over that story again, item by item, that long litany of hostility he plowed through. That will shoot adrenaline into your souls!
- 3 Consider him who endured such opposition from sinful men, so that you will not grow weary and lose heart.
- 4 In this all-out match against sin, others have suffered far worse than you, to say nothing of what Jesus went through--all that bloodshed!
- 4 In your struggle against sin, you have not yet resisted to the point of shedding your blood.
- 5 So don't feel sorry for yourselves. Or have you forgotten how good parents treat children, and that God regards you as his children? My dear child, don't shrug off God's discipline, but don't be crushed by it either.
- 5 And you have forgotten that word of encouragement that addresses you as sons: "My son, do not make light of the Lord's discipline, and do not lose heart when he rebukes you,
- 6 It's the child he loves that he disciplines; the child he embraces, he also corrects.
- 6 because the Lord disciplines those he loves, and he punishes everyone he accepts as a son."

- 7 God is educating you; that's why you must never drop out. He's treating you as dear children. This trouble you're in isn't punishment; it's training,
- 7 Endure hardship as discipline; God is treating you as sons. For what son is not disciplined by his father?
- 8 the normal experience of children. Only irresponsible parents leave children to fend for themselves. Would you prefer an irresponsible God?
- 8 If you are not disciplined (and everyone undergoes discipline), then you are illegitimate children and not true sons.
- 9 We respect our own parents for training and not spoiling us, so why not embrace God's training so we can truly live?
- 9 Moreover, we have all had human fathers who disciplined us and we respected them for it. How much more should we submit to the Father of our spirits and live!
- 10 While we were children, our parents did what seemed best to them. But God is doing what is best for us, training us to live God's holy best.
- 10 Our fathers disciplined us for a little while as they thought best; but God disciplines us for our good, that we may share in his holiness.
- 11 At the time, discipline isn't much fun. It always feels like it's going against the grain. Later, of course, it pays off handsomely, for it's the well-trained who find themselves mature in their relationship with God.
- 11 No discipline seems pleasant at the time, but painful. Later on, however, it produces a harvest of righteousness and peace for those who have been trained by it.
- 12 So don't sit around on your hands! No more dragging your feet!
- 12 Therefore, strengthen your feeble arms and weak knees.
- 13 Clear the path for long-distance runners so no one will trip and fall, so no one will step in a hole and sprain an ankle. Help each other out. And run for it!
- 13 Make level paths for your feet, so that the lame may not be disabled, but rather healed.
- 14 Work at getting along with each other and with God. Otherwise you'll never get so much as a glimpse of God.
- 14 Make every effort to live in peace with all men and to be holy; without holiness no one will see the Lord.
- 15 Make sure no one gets left out of God's generosity. Keep a sharp eye out for weeds of bitter discontent. A thistle or two gone to seed can ruin a

whole garden in no time.

15 See to it that no one misses the grace of God and that no bitter root grows up to cause trouble and defile many.

16 Watch out for the Esau syndrome: trading away God's lifelong gift in order to satisfy a short-term appetite.

16 See that no one is sexually immoral, or is godless like Esau, who for a single meal sold his inheritance rights as the oldest son.

17 You well know how Esau later regretted that impulsive act and wanted God's blessing--but by then it was too late, tears or no tears.

17 Afterward, as you know, when he wanted to inherit this blessing, he was rejected. He could bring about no change of mind, though he sought the blessing with tears.

18 Unlike your ancestors, you didn't come to Mount Sinai--all that volcanic blaze and earthshaking rumble--

18 You have not come to a mountain that can be touched and that is burning with fire; to darkness, gloom and storm;

19 to hear God speak. The earsplitting words and soul-shaking message terrified them and they begged him to stop.

19 to a trumpet blast or to such a voice speaking words that those who heard it begged that no further word be spoken to them,

20 When they heard the words--"If an animal touches the Mountain, it's as good as dead"--they were afraid to move.

20 because they could not bear what was commanded: "If even an animal touches the mountain, it must be stoned."

21 Even Moses was terrified.

21 The sight was so terrifying that Moses said, "I am trembling with fear."

22 No, that's not your experience at all. You've come to Mount Zion, the city where the living God resides. The invisible Jerusalem is populated by throngs of festive angels

22 But you have come to Mount Zion, to the heavenly Jerusalem, the city of the living God. You have come to thousands upon thousands of angels in joyful assembly,

23 and Christian citizens. It is the city where God is Judge, with judgments that make us just.

23 to the church of the firstborn, whose names are written in heaven. You have come to God, the judge of all men, to the spirits of righteous men

- made perfect,
- 24 You've come to Jesus, who presents us with a new covenant, a fresh charter from God. He is the Mediator of this covenant. The murder of Jesus, unlike Abel's--a homicide that cried out for vengeance--became a proclamation of grace.
- 24 to Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel.
- 25 So don't turn a deaf ear to these gracious words. If those who ignored earthly warnings didn't get away with it, what will happen to us if we turn our backs on heavenly warnings?
- 25 See to it that you do not refuse him who speaks. If they did not escape when they refused him who warned them on earth, how much less will we, if we turn away from him who warns us from heaven?
- 26 His voice that time shook the earth to its foundations; this time--he's told us this quite plainly--he'll also rock the heavens: "One last shaking, from top to bottom, stem to stern."
- 26 At that time his voice shook the earth, but now he has promised, "Once more I will shake not only the earth but also the heavens."
- 27 The phrase "one last shaking" means a thorough housecleaning, getting rid of all the historical and religious junk so that the unshakable essentials stand clear and uncluttered.
- 27 The words "once more" indicate the removing of what can be shaken--that is, created things--so that what cannot be shaken may remain.
- 28 Do you see what we've got? An unshakable kingdom! And do you see how thankful we must be? Not only thankful, but brimming with worship, deeply reverent before God. For God is not an indifferent bystander.
- 28 Therefore, since we are receiving a kingdom that cannot be shaken, let us be thankful, and so worship God acceptably with reverence and awe,
- 29 He's actively cleaning house, torching all that needs to burn, and he won't quit until it's all cleansed. God himself is Fire!
- 29 for our "God is a consuming fire."

Hebrews 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 Stay on good terms with each other, held together by love.
- 1 Keep on loving each other as brothers.
- 2 Be ready with a meal or a bed when it's needed. Why, some have extended hospitality to angels without ever knowing it!
- 2 Do not forget to entertain strangers, for by so doing some people have entertained angels without knowing it.
- 3 Regard prisoners as if you were in prison with them. Look on victims of abuse as if what happened to them had happened to you.
- 3 Remember those in prison as if you were their fellow prisoners, and those who are mistreated as if you yourselves were suffering.
- 4 Honor marriage, and guard the sacredness of sexual intimacy between wife and husband. God draws a firm line against casual and illicit sex.
- 4 Marriage should be honored by all, and the marriage bed kept pure, for God will judge the adulterer and all the sexually immoral.
- 5 Don't be obsessed with getting more material things. Be relaxed with what you have. Since God assured us, "I'll never let you down, never walk off and leave you,"
- 5 Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, because God has said, "Never will I leave you; never will I forsake you."
- 6 we can boldly quote, God is there, ready to help; I'm fearless no matter what. Who or what can get to me?
- 6 So we say with confidence, "The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?"
- 7 Appreciate your pastoral leaders who gave you the Word of God. Take a good look at the way they live, and let their faithfulness instruct you, as well as their truthfulness. There should be a consistency that runs through us all.
- 7 Remember your leaders, who spoke the word of God to you. Consider the outcome of their way of life and imitate their faith.
- 8 For Jesus doesn't change--yesterday, today, tomorrow, he's always totally himself.
- 8 Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever.
- 9 Don't be lured away from him by the latest speculations about him. The grace of Christ is the only good ground for life. Products named after

Christ don't seem to do much for those who buy them.

- 9 Do not be carried away by all kinds of strange teachings. It is good for our hearts to be strengthened by grace, not by ceremonial foods, which are of no value to those who eat them.
- 10 The altar from which God gives us the gift of himself is not for exploitation by insiders who grab and loot.
- 10 We have an altar from which those who minister at the tabernacle have no right to eat.
- 11 In the old system, the animals are killed and the bodies disposed of outside the camp. The blood is then brought inside to the altar as a sacrifice for sin.
- 11 The high priest carries the blood of animals into the Most Holy Place as a sin offering, but the bodies are burned outside the camp.
- 12 It's the same with Jesus. He was crucified outside the city gates--that is where he poured out the sacrificial blood that was brought to God's altar to cleanse his people.
- 12 And so Jesus also suffered outside the city gate to make the people holy through his own blood.
- 13 So let's go outside, where Jesus is, where the action is--not trying to be privileged insiders, but taking our share in the abuse of Jesus.
- 13 Let us, then, go to him outside the camp, bearing the disgrace he bore.
- 14 This "insider world" is not our home. We have our eyes peeled for the City about to come.
- 14 For here we do not have an enduring city, but we are looking for the city that is to come.
- 15 Let's take our place outside with Jesus, no longer pouring out the sacrificial blood of animals but pouring out sacrificial praises from our lips to God in Jesus' name.
- 15 Through Jesus, therefore, let us continually offer to God a sacrifice of praise--the fruit of lips that confess his name.
- 16 Make sure you don't take things for granted and go slack in working for the common good; share what you have with others. God takes particular pleasure in acts of worship--a different kind of "sacrifice"--that take place in kitchen and workplace and on the streets.
- 16 And do not forget to do good and to share with others, for with such sacrifices God is pleased.

- 17 Be responsive to your pastoral leaders. Listen to their counsel. They are alert to the condition of your lives and work under the strict supervision of God. Contribute to the joy of their leadership, not its drudgery. Why would you want to make things harder for them?
- 17 Obey your leaders and submit to their authority. They keep watch over you as men who must give an account. Obey them so that their work will be a joy, not a burden, for that would be of no advantage to you.
- 18 Pray for us. We have no doubts about what we're doing or why, but it's hard going and we need your prayers. All we care about is living well before God.
- 18 Pray for us. We are sure that we have a clear conscience and desire to live honorably in every way.
- 19 Pray that we may be together soon.
- 19 I particularly urge you to pray so that I may be restored to you soon.
- 20 May God, who puts all things together, makes all things whole, Who made a lasting mark through the sacrifice of Jesus, the sacrifice of blood that sealed the eternal covenant, Who led Jesus, our Great Shepherd, up and alive from the dead,
- 20 May the God of peace, who through the blood of the eternal covenant brought back from the dead our Lord Jesus, that great Shepherd of the sheep,
- 21 Now put you together, provide you with everything you need to please him, Make us into what gives him most pleasure, by means of the sacrifice of Jesus, the Messiah. All glory to Jesus forever and always! Oh, yes, yes, yes.
- 21 equip you with everything good for doing his will, and may he work in us what is pleasing to him, through Jesus Christ, to whom be glory for ever and ever. Amen.
- 22 Friends, please take what I've written most seriously. I've kept this as brief as possible; I haven't piled on a lot of extras.
- 22 Brothers, I urge you to bear with my word of exhortation, for I have written you only a short letter.
- 23 You'll be glad to know that Timothy has been let out of prison. If he leaves soon, I'll come with him and get to see you myself.
- 23 I want you to know that our brother Timothy has been released. If he arrives soon, I will come with him to see you.

24 Say hello to your pastoral leaders and all the congregations. Everyone here in Italy wants to be remembered to you.

24 Greet all your leaders and all God's people. Those from Italy send you their greetings.

25 Grace be with you, every one.

25 Grace be with you all.